



▲ **Delphic oracle**

In this fresco from a vase fragment, the god Apollo speaks to the priestess, the Pythia, at Delphi. In an oracular ceremony, the Pythia sat on a cooking tripod and delivered her message in hexameter verse, said to be inspired by the god himself.

“Let us ask some seer or priest, or
some reader of dreams ... who might say
why Phoebus Apollo is so angry.”

HOMER, *ILIAD* (1.62–67)